Unit 6 — Interview and Portrait

Track E · Klasse 9 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can prepare 8 open interview questions.*
- *I can hold a 5-minute interview and report it back in writing.*
- *I can write a 150-word portrait of a real person.*

Lead-in I

Naima is interviewing the school caretaker, Mrs. Brock, who has worked at the school for 21 years and claims to remember every student's name. She is almost certainly exaggerating. Naima has prepared eight open questions and one fall-back question, *tell me about a student you remember*, in case the interview stalls.

Vocabulary I

- interview
- interviewer
- interviewee
- open question (Wh-)
- closed question (yes/no)
- follow-up
- transcript
- off the record
- on the record
- quote
- paraphrase

Reading I

Interview vocabulary
interview, interviewer, interviewee, open question (Wh-), closed question (yes/no), follow-up, transcript, off the record, on the record, quote, paraphrase.

Open question forms

- *Tell me about …*
- *Could you describe …?*
- *What was it like when …?*

Reading II

- *How did you decide to …?*
- *Why did you choose …?*
- *What do you remember most about …?*

Reporting an interview in writing
Direct: *”I remember the day,” she said.* Reported: *She said she remembered the day.* Mixed (allowed in journalism): use one short direct quote per paragraph + reported speech around it.

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Mark open or closed: *Did you enjoy your job? — Tell me about your first day. — How long have you been here?*
2. Rewrite as open: *Did you have a favourite student?* → ___ .

Niveau E — productive

3. Prepare 8 open interview questions for an imagined interviewee.

Your turn I

Interview + 150-word portrait. In pairs, run a 5-minute interview based on 8 open questions. Then write a 150-word portrait of your interviewee with at least one direct quote and 4 sentences of reported speech.

Sample

Mrs. Brock has worked at our school for 21 years. She says she remembers every student's name, and the way she said this, leaning forward slightly, made me almost believe her. "You forget faces but you remember voices," she told me. She came to the school because her sister-in-law had worked here in the 90s. She added, smiling, that her favourite part of the job was the empty corridor between 7:30 and 7:55 in the morning. "Best minutes of the building," she said.

Your turn II

”Everything is about to start, and nothing has gone wrong yet.”

Reflect I

- I can prepare 8 open interview questions.
- I can run a 5-minute interview.
- I can write a 150-word portrait with one direct quote.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC News — *In Pictures* / portrait journalism.
- The Guardian — *Long reads* (selected).